

Tool: Prioritize HR Processes for AI Transformation

17 March 2026 - ID G00850405 - 3 min read

By: Seyda Berger-Böcker, Hanne Nieberg

Initiatives: Functional Design; Transform HR through AI

Knowing where to start with AI is difficult for CHROs due to unclear visibility into where AI creates the most value across HR processes. This tool supplies CHROs with predefined AI impact scores across HR processes and enables prioritization of investments based on strategic process value and current performance.

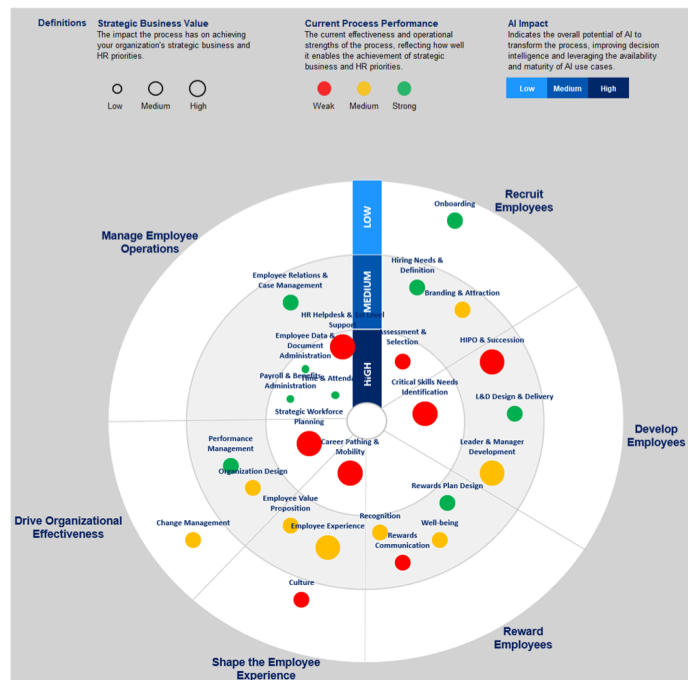
When to Use

AI capabilities are advancing rapidly, yet realizing their value depends less on the technology itself and more on how organizations redesign critical processes around AI. However, without clarity on which HR processes should evolve first, CHROs struggle to translate AI potential into focused investment decisions, causing AI initiatives to remain fragmented and impact to fall short of expectations.

This tool provides CHROs with a fact-based approach to identify where AI can generate the greatest business value across the HR function, whether at the start of their AI journey or when sharpening their HR transformation agenda. It provides a predefined view of AI's impact across HR processes and enables CHROs to assess them based on strategic business value and current performance. This supports confident prioritization and targeted investments, focusing transformation efforts where AI can create the greatest advantage (see Figure 1).

Figure 1: AI Impact-Value Navigator

AI Impact-Value Navigator



Source: Gartner
850405

Gartner

Directions for Use

Step 1: Review Defined AI Impact

Review the predefined AI impact ratings to understand how AI impacts HR at the process level (see Figure 2). AI does not create a uniform shift across HR. Instead, the degree and nature of its impact differ by process, driven by varying potential to transform workflows, enhance decision intelligence and deploy mature, scalable AI use cases. While AI accelerates efficiency and decision intelligence in many HR processes, others remain less exposed and continue to rely heavily on human-led value. Recognizing these differences distinguishes high-performing HR functions and is critical for effective AI investment decisions. For more clarity on where AI accelerates process execution, improves decision intelligence and is ready to scale, see [Understand the Impact of AI Across HR Processes to Accelerate HR Transformation](#).

Figure 2: AI Impact Ratings

AI Impact Ratings

Review the predefined AI impact ratings to understand how AI impacts HR at the process level.

HR Category	HR Activity	Definition	Dimension 1 AI Process Transformation Impact The extent to which AI changes how the process is executed, automates workflows and addresses stakeholders and their	Dimension 2 AI Decision Intelligence Impact The extent to which AI enhances how decisions are made by improving insight quality, speed and	Dimension 3 AI Use Case Availability The maturity and scalability of existing AI solutions across each HR process	Overall AI Impact
			AI Process Transformation Impact	AI Decision Intelligence Impact	AI Use Case Availability	
Recruit Employees	Hiring Needs & Definition	How the organization forecasts the roles needed to support the strategy and scopes individual jobs as they open.	Medium	High	Medium	MEDIUM
	Branding & Attraction	How the organization builds candidates' understanding of the value proposition to attract the best talent for hard-to-fill roles.	Medium	Low	Medium	MEDIUM
	Assessment & Selection	How the organization evaluates and chooses the best-fit talent to fill critical skills gaps.	High	High	High	HIGH
Develop Employees	Onboarding	How the organization integrates a new hire into the organization and their role in order to improve time to productivity and initial engagement.	Low	Low	Low	LOW
	Critical Skills Needs Identification	How the organization identifies the skills employees need to perform their jobs today and in the future.	High	Medium	High	HIGH
	L&D Design & Delivery	How the organization ensures employees have access to the most relevant learning and development (L&D) solutions when and where they need them.	Medium	Low	Medium	MEDIUM
Reward Employees	Leader & Manager Development	How the organization builds the mindsets, skills and behaviors that leaders and managers at all levels need to drive the business forward.	Medium	Medium	Medium	MEDIUM
	HPO & Succession	How the organization identifies, develops and engages the group of individuals who will fill future leadership roles.	Medium	High	Medium	MEDIUM
	Rewards Plan Design	How the organization designs compensation and benefits offerings to drive employee attraction, retention and performance.	Medium	Medium	High	MEDIUM
Shape the Employee Experience	Rewards Communication	How the organization helps employees understand their total rewards programs and how to maximize their own rewards portfolio.	High	Medium	Medium	MEDIUM
	Recognition	How the organization uses monetary and nonmonetary awards to acknowledge specific contributions employees make toward achieving business goals.	Medium	Medium	Medium	MEDIUM
	Well-being	How the organization protects and enhances employees well-being, including employees' physical, mental, emotional, financial and career well-being.	Medium	High	Low	MEDIUM
Drive Organizational Effectiveness	Employee Experience	How the organization protects and enhances employees' everyday interactions to ensure alignment with the company's vision & desired organizational culture to drive engagement and performance.	Medium	High	Medium	MEDIUM
	Culture	How the organization measures and manages the behavioral norms and unwritten rules that shape the organizational environment and how individuals interact within it.	Low	Medium	Low	LOW
	Employee Value Proposition	How the organization defines and manages the value the labor market and employees perceive they gain from employment with the organization.	Medium	Medium	Medium	MEDIUM
Manage Employee Operations	Career Pathing & Mobility	How the organization engineers employee movement between career experiences to maximize their development and meet business needs.	High	High	High	HIGH
	Strategic Workforce Planning	How the organization identifies the capabilities needed for the future business strategy and ensures the right mix of talent, technologies and employment models to reach those goals.	High	High	High	HIGH
	Performance Management	How the organization establishes, motivates, evaluates and rewards the achievement of employee performance goals.	Medium	High	Medium	MEDIUM
	Organization Design	How the HR function supports leaders in making intentional decisions about their structure, workflow, governance, role design, and resourcing to achieve organizational effectiveness.	Medium	Medium	Low	MEDIUM
	Change Management	How the organization supports leaders and employees in managing, implementing, and adapting to change.	Low	Medium	Low	LOW
	Employee Data & Document Administration	How the organization manages and governs employee data and documents to ensure accuracy, compliance and seamless lifecycle transition.	High	Medium	High	HIGH
	Time & Attendance	How the organization tracks, validates and manages employee working hours, schedules and absence to ensure compliance and operational continuity.	High	Medium	High	HIGH
	Payroll & Benefits Administration	How the organization processes employee pay and administers benefits to deliver accurate, timely and compliant compensation and rewards.	High	High	High	HIGH
	Employee Relations & Case Management	How the organization investigates and resolves employee concerns and workplace conflicts through structured, fair and compliant case processes.	Medium	Medium	Medium	MEDIUM
	HR Helpdesk & 3rd Level Support	How the organization provides employees with timely answers, guidance and issue resolution through frontline service channels.	High	Medium	High	HIGH

Source: Gartner
850405

Gartner

Step 2: Assess Value and Performance of Your HR Processes

Use the input sheet (see Figure 3) to evaluate each HR process based on:

- **Strategic business value:** The extent to which the HR process contributes to achieving your organization's strategic priorities and business objectives (high, medium and low).
- **Current process performance:** The effectiveness and maturity with which the HR process is currently executed within your HR function (weak, medium and strong)

Figure 3: HR Process Evaluation

HR Process Evaluation

The main working sheet to evaluate each HR process based on strategic business value and current process performance.

		Dimension 1 Strategic Business Value The extent to which the HR process contributes to achieving your organization's strategic priorities and business objectives.		Dimension 2 Current Process Performance The effectiveness and maturity with which the HR process is currently executed within your HR function.	
HR Category	HR Activity	Definition			
Recruit Employees	Hiring Needs & Definition	How the organization forecasts the roles needed to support the strategy and scopes individual roles as they open.	Medium	Strong	
	Branding & Attraction	How the organization builds candidates' understanding of the value proposition to attract the best talent for hard-to-fill roles.	Medium	Medium	
	Assessment & Selection	How the organization evaluates and chooses the best-fit talent to fill critical skills gaps.	Medium	Weak	
	Onboarding	How the organization integrates a new hire into the organization and their role in order to improve time to productivity and initial engagement.	Medium	Strong	
Develop Employees	Critical Skills Needs Identification	How the organization identifies the skills employees need to perform their jobs today and in the future.	High	Weak	
	L&D Design & Delivery	How the organization ensures employees have access to the most relevant learning and development (L&D) solutions when and where they need them.	Medium	Strong	
	Leader & Manager Development	How the organization builds the mindsets, skills and behaviors that leaders and managers at all levels need to drive the business forward.	High	Medium	
	HRD & Succession	How the organization identifies, develops and engages the group of individuals who will fill future leadership roles.	High	Weak	
Reward Employees	Rewards Plan Design	How the organization designs compensation and benefits offerings to drive employee attraction, retention and performance.	Medium	Strong	
	Rewards Communication	How the organization helps employees understand their total rewards programs and how to maximize their own rewards portfolio.	Medium	Weak	
	Recognition	How the organization uses monetary and nonmonetary awards to acknowledge specific contributions employees make toward achieving business goals.	Medium	Medium	
	Well-being	How the organization protects and enhances employee well-being, including employees' physical, mental, emotional, financial and career well-being.	Medium	Medium	
Shape the Employee Experience	Employee Experience	How the organization structures, orchestrates & shapes employees' everyday interactions to ensure engagement with the promised EVP & desired organizational culture to drive engagement and performance.	High	Medium	
	Culture	How the organization measures and manages the behavioral norms and unwritten rules that shape the organizational environment and how individuals interact within it.	Medium	Weak	
	Employee Value Proposition	How the organization defines and manages the value the labor market and employees perceive they gain from employment with the organization.	Medium	Medium	
	Career Pathing & Mobility	How the organization engineers employee movement between career experiences to maximize their development and meet business needs.	High	Weak	
Drive Organizational Effectiveness	Strategic Workforce Planning	How the organization identifies the capabilities needed for the future business strategy and ensures the right mix of talent, technologies and employment models to reach those goals.	High	Weak	
	Performance Management	How the organization establishes, motivates, evaluates and rewards the achievement of employee performance goals.	Medium	Strong	
	Organization Design	How the HR function supports leaders in making operational decisions about their structure, workflow, governance, HR design, and resources to achieve organizational effectiveness.	Medium	Medium	
	Change Management	How the organization supports leaders and employees in managing, implementing, and adapting to change.	Medium	Medium	
Manage Employee Operations	Employee Data & Document Administration	How the organization manages and governs employee data and documents to ensure accuracy, compliance and seamless HR service provision.	Medium	Strong	
	Time & Attendance	How the organization tracks, validates and manages employee working hours, schedules and absence to ensure compliance and operational continuity.	Medium	Medium	
	Payroll & Benefits Administration	How the organization processes employee pay and administers benefits to deliver accurate, timely and compliant compensation and rewards.	Medium	Strong	
	Employee Relations & Case Management	How the organization investigates and resolves employee concerns and workplace conflicts through structured, fair and compliant case processes.	Medium	Strong	
	HR Helpdesk & 1st Level Support	How the organization provides employees with timely answers, guidance and issue resolution through frontline service channels.	High	Weak	

Source: Gartner
850405

Gartner

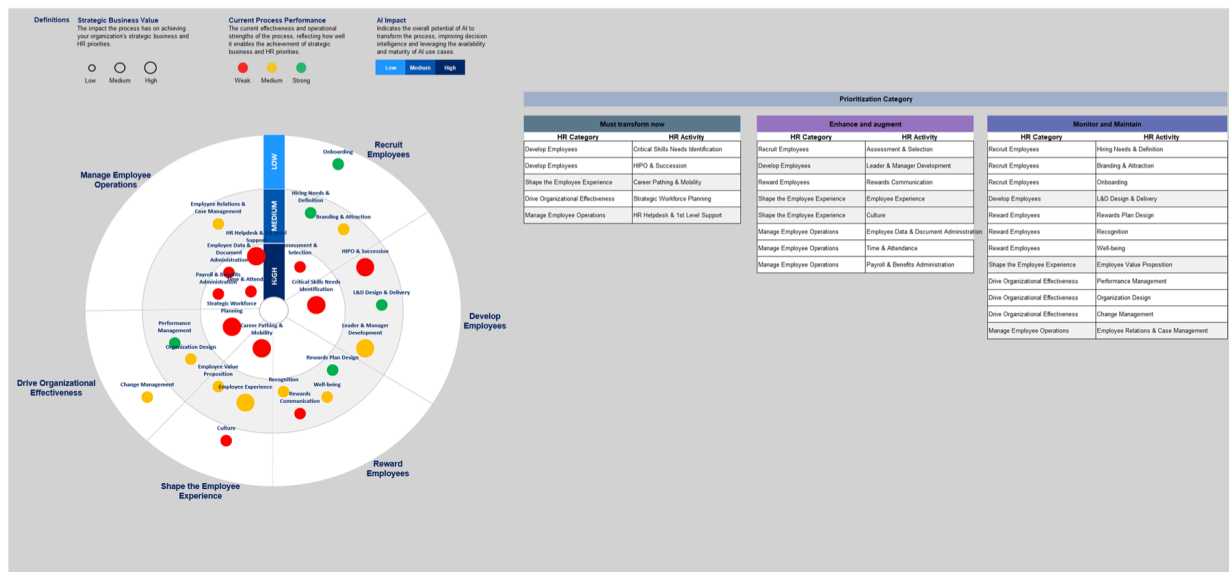
Step 3: Interpret Your AI Impact-Value Navigator

Once Step 2 is completed, the AI impact-value navigator visualizes your HR processes across levels of strategic business value (bubble size) and current process performance (bubble color) positioned within predefined high-, medium- and low-AI impact opportunities. This holistic view enables a quick understanding of which HR processes are strategically important, how effectively they perform today, and where AI investments will deliver the highest value. Based on these insights, the tool organizes your HR processes into three prioritization categories (see Figure 4):

- Must transform now
- Enhance and augment
- Monitor and maintain

Figure 4: AI Impact-Value Navigator

AI Impact-Value Navigator



Source: Gartner
850405

Gartner

Step 4: Plan for Next Steps

- Align on priorities:** Validate the identified priority processes with HR and business leaders to confirm strategic alignment and organizational relevance.
- Define AI transformation objectives:** Clarify what success looks like for priority processes by defining target outcomes, value expectations and improvement targets.
- Identify AI use cases:** Define concrete AI use cases for priority processes while balancing value with feasibility (see [AI Use-Case Assessment for HR](#), [AI Use-Case Assessment for Learning and Development](#), [AI Use-Case Assessment for Talent Acquisition \[Recruiting\]](#) and [AI Use-Case Assessment for Talent Management](#)).
- Defined enablement needs:** Assess required changes to process workflows, roles and responsibility splits, skills and technology.
- Reassess regularly:** Revisit priorities periodically as organizational strategy, process maturity and AI capabilities evolve.

Evidence

Contributors

Aanya Jain, Mohammed Yousuf

Disclaimer: Unless otherwise marked for external use, the items in this Gartner Tool are for internal noncommercial use by the licensed Gartner client. The materials contained in this Tool may not be repackaged or resold. Gartner makes no representations or warranties as to the suitability of this Tool for any particular purpose, and disclaims all liabilities for any damages, whether direct, consequential, incidental or special, arising out of the use of or inability to use this material or the information provided herein.

Recommended by the Authors

Some documents may not be available as part of your current Gartner subscription.

[Understand the Impact of AI Across HR Processes to Accelerate HR Transformation](#)

[Infographic: AI's Impact Across HR Processes](#)

[The Impact of AI on the HR Operating Model](#)

© 2026 Gartner, Inc. and/or its affiliates. All rights reserved. Gartner is a registered trademark of Gartner, Inc. and its affiliates. This publication may not be reproduced or distributed in any form without Gartner's prior written permission. It consists of the opinions of Gartner's Business and Technology Insights Organization, which should not be construed as statements of fact. While the information contained in this publication has been obtained from sources believed to be reliable, Gartner disclaims all warranties as to the accuracy, completeness or adequacy of such information. Although Gartner insights may address legal and financial issues, Gartner does not provide legal or investment advice and its insights should not be construed or used as such. Your access and use of this publication are governed by [Gartner's Usage Policy](#). Gartner prides itself on its reputation for independence and objectivity. Its insights is produced independently by its Business and Technology Insights Organization without input or influence from any third party. For further information, see "[Guiding Principles on Independence and Objectivity](#)." Gartner insights may not be used as input into or for the training or development of generative artificial intelligence, machine learning, algorithms, software, or related technologies.